aid to support the Algerians in their fight for independence from France.

In October the British joined the French and Israelis. On 24 October, the British and French Foreign Ministers secretly met the Israeli Prime Minister, David Ben-Gurion, in France. Ben-Gurion wished to end the border raids from Gaza and force Egypt to recognise the state of Israel. He also wanted to break the Egyptian **blockade** of the Tiran Straits which prevented Israeli ships from reaching the port of Eilat (see the map below). Furthermore, he was worried about the increasing military strength of Egypt and the fact that the armies of Egypt, Syria and Jordan had been put under the same command. Britain, France and Israel held further high-level meetings. Although it was denied at the time, a joint campaign against Egypt was being planned.

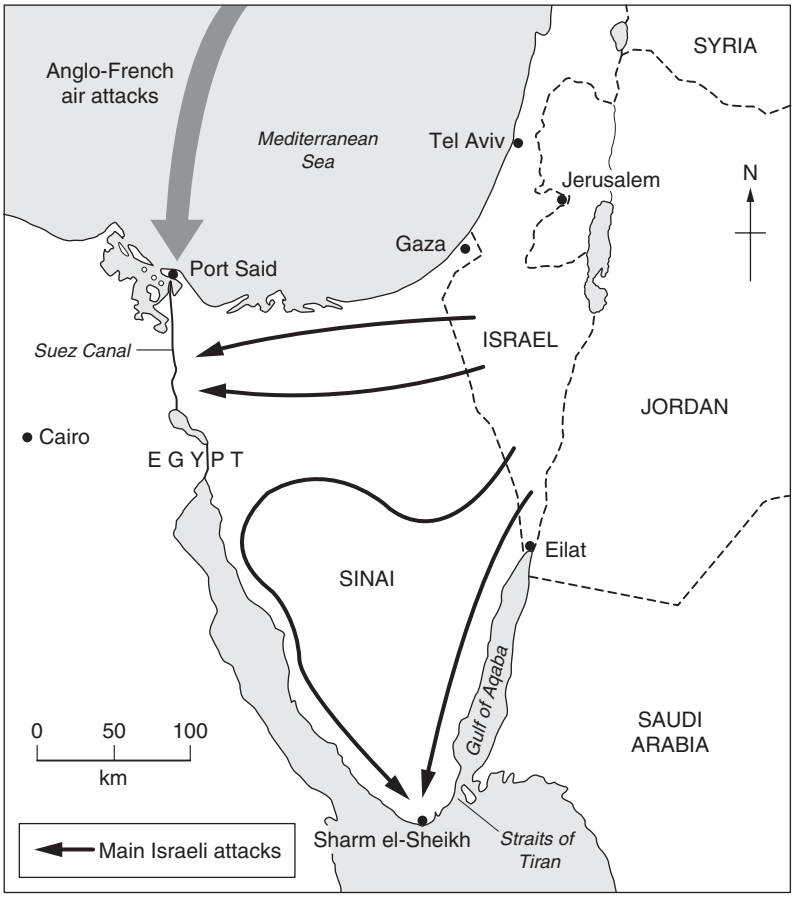
Key term

Blockade
The blocking of a place or region by troops or ships to prevent goods or people reaching it.

The fighting over Suez

Key question
What happened in the Suez War?

On 29 October 1956, Israeli forces invaded Egypt. They advanced across Sinai towards the Suez Canal (see the map below). The next day, the governments of Britain and France ordered Egypt and Israel to cease fighting and withdraw 10 miles from the Canal. If either side refused, the British and French



The 1956 Suez War. The Straits of Tiran were Israel's outlet to trade with Asia and Africa.